

CART-498

Self-Reflection of Generative AI

My relationship with AI is weird. As I assume it is the same for most people. My understanding of how it functions is slightly higher than basic standard. I understand the way neural network's function, how they train data sets, and the difference between classification, regression, and generative. I'm also aware of a lot of its uses. From LLM's to video generation, its reach has yet to be determined. This is my second class on AI, and I am excited to learn more in depth about how generative AI functions. However, I am more curious about the society's reaction and integration of this emerging technology.

There is a big push back I've noticed when discussing AI with my friends and colleagues. A lot of people demonize AI as this end bringer of humanity. While I am a user of LLMs, I understand the ethical and environmental concerns of this technology. I don't know where they got the data these models are trained on, what biases they may have, and the validity of the information given. When I use AI, I try to use it with the utmost scrutiny. My relationship with AI becomes even more complicated in an art context. The big concern for me is authorship. If I make an art piece with the help of generative AI, at what point of its usage does it no longer remain my art piece?

An example of generative AI art that I find inspiring is Mario Klingemann's piece *Memories of Passerby I*. This artwork is a fully autonomous installation piece that continuously generates a stream of portraits on two framed screens. The brain of the AI is housed in a wooden cabinet, in which Klingemann trained the algorithm using portraits from the 17th to 19th century. He utilizes supervised learning to teach the machine his own aesthetic preferences. Interestingly, he was inspired by Max Ernst for this piece just like this assignment. The reason I connect with this piece is how it turns data into identity, but of non-existent people. It only exists as a statistical approximation.